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PROJECT TWINKLE
FINAL REPORT

L. ELTERMAN

27 November 1951

APPROVED:

P. H. WYCKOFF
Chief, Atmospheric Physics Laboratory

DOWNGRADED AT 3 YEAR INTERVALS;
DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS.
DOD DIR 5200.10

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YCBethune

PROJECT 10073 RECORD CARD

1. DATE 10 Feb 1951		2. LOCATION 49.50N 50.03W (Atlantic)		12. CONCLUSIONS ☐ Was Balloon ☐ Probably Balloon ☐ Possibly Balloon ☐ Was Aircraft ☐ Probably Aircraft ☐ Possibly Aircraft ☒ Was Astronomical <i>AL ROKS</i> ☐ Probably Astronomical ☐ Possibly Astronomical ☐ Other ☐ Insufficient Data for Evaluation ☐ Unknown	
3. DATE-TIME GROUP Local GMT 0055Z (N)		4. TYPE OF OBSERVATION ☐ Ground-Visual ☒ Air-Visual ☐ Ground-Radar ☐ Air-Intercept Radar			
5. PHOTOS ☐ Yes ☒ No		6. SOURCE MIL			
7. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION 7-8 Min		8. NUMBER OF OBJECTS 1		9. COURSE E-	
10. BRIEF SUMMARY OF SIGHTING Yellowish light, like a fire in color, approached the observing ACFT and grew very bright and very large with a semi-circular shape. It suddenly turned 180 deg and disappeared over the horizon at terrific speed.				11. COMMENTS Believed to be Aurora display by consulting astronomer.	

COUNTRY

REG. NO.

IR-4-51

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AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

SUBJECT

Reporting of Information on Unconventional Aircraft/Object

AREA REPORTED ON

North Atlantic

FROM (Agency)

Dir/Int, Hq NEAC

DATE OF REPORT

12 March 1951

DATE OF INFORMATION

10 February 1951

EVALUATION

C-3

PREPARED BY (Officer)

SOURCE

C-54 crew of Navy VR-1 Sq, based
at Patuxent, Maryland

REFERENCES (Control number, directive, previous report, etc., as applicable)

SUMMARY: (Enter concise summary of report. Give significance in final one-sentence paragraph. List inclosures at lower left. Begin text of report on AF Form 112-Part II.)

Attached is a report on an unidentified air object forwarded in accordance with letter, Headquarters, USAF, File AFOIC-CC-1, Subj: Reporting of Information on Unconventional Aircraft, dated 8 September 1950. Report is unconfirmed by other sources.

APPROVED:

For *Kenneth D. Maxwell*
HUGH D. MAXWELL, JR.

Lt Col, USAF

Director of Intelligence

ITEM 4 AMC /~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
FROM JJ RODGERS MCIAXA-1A
TO COL HARRIS AFOIN-V/TC

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TT-071-PH
20 February 5
MCIAXA/Rodgers

REFERENCE RECENT RADNOTE MESSAGES FROM YOUR HEADQUARTERS CONCERNING SIGHTING OF UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECT IN THE VICINITY OF NEWFOUNDLAND BY NAVY AIRCREW. BASED UPON THE INFORMATION PRESENTED, IT IS IMPOSSIBLE TO COME TO DEFINITE CONCLUSIONS REGARDING THE SIGHTING. HOWEVER, THE MATTER WAS DISCUSSED IN SOME DETAIL WITH AN ASTRONOMER ATTACHED TO THE AMC GRADUATE CENTER AS A RESULT OF THIS DISCUSSION IT WAS CONCLUDED THAT WHILE THERE IS A POSSIBILITY OF THE OBJECT SIGHTED BEING A METEOR OR FIREBALL, THE DESCRIPTION FURNISHED GIVES REASON TO BELIEVE THAT THE AIRCREW SAW AN UNUSUAL "NORTHERN LIGHTS" DISPLAY. NO FURTHER ACTION IS CONTEMPLATED ON THIS INCIDENT UNLESS ADDITIONAL INFORMATION IS RECEIVED WHICH WOULD TEND TO CHANGE OUR ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION.

INFORMATION

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END ITEM 4 AMC /~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
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075-25303

TO CGAMC WP AFB OHIO

AF GRNC

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1/4 E S ~~SECRET~~ BY RADNOTE FOR MCISXD FROM AFOIN-C/DD-13/CAPT OSTRE
THE FOLLOWING CABLE IS QUOTED FOR YOUR INFORMATION: "VR-1 PILOTS OFF
LIGHT N-125 ENROUTE KEFLAVIK TO ARGENTIA ON COURSE 225 TRUE
AT 10,000 FEET REPORTED AN UNIDENTIFIED RED AND YELLOW OBJECT AT
100055Z INITIALLY BEARING 060 RELATIVE. OBJECT APPEARED TO BE CLOSE
TO SURFACE. SHAPE INDEFINITE WHEN FIRST SIGHTED LATER APPEARING
CIRCULAR. DIAMETER ESTIMATE EXCESS 400 FEET. OBJECT APPROACHED
PLANE TURNED AND DISAPPEARED OVER HORIZON ON COURSE 290 TRUE AT
TREMENDOUS SPEED. 100055Z POSITION LATITUDE 49-50 NORTH LONG 50-13
SIGHTING REPORTED TO GARGEN APO PLAIN LANGUAGE."

SUBJECT: Unidentified Object

MCIA
Col Feiling

MCI

14 Feb 51

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Request that you give me a short resume of action taken in connection with the inclosed cables concerning an unidentified object in the general vicinity of Newfoundland.

3 Incls	/s/ HAROLD E. WATSON	Honaker/mb
1. Cy inc msg (1-lp) 51S-20766-2	Colonel, USAF	59210
2. Cy inc msg (1-lp) 51S-20769-2	Chief, Intel Dept	Bldg 263B
3. " " " (1-lp) 51S-22120-2		P B21

MCI

MCIAXA-1a

20 Feb 51

2

1. The inclosed cables were reviewed by this office in light of criteria which has been developed up to the present time in the investigation of such incidents. The matter was also discussed with an astronomer attached to the Graduate Center at Area 3.
2. As a result, it was concluded that while there is a possibility of the object being a meteor or a fireball, the description furnished gives reason to believe that the aircrew actually saw an unusual "northern lights" display.
3. This information is being passed on to TCS, Hq USAF.

Incls:
n/c

KENT PARROT	60267eps
Lt Colonel, USAF	6-5376
Chief, Aircraft & Propulsion Sec	P D-11
Technical Analysis Division	B 263D
Intelligence Department	

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FROM: NORTH EAST AIR COMD, PEPPERRELL AFB, NFLD

TO : CSAF WASH D C

NR : EN 0215

10 Feb 51

(DTG 101500Z)

Reference NEAC EN 0212 DTG 100400Z. Additional info on unidentified object, wea clear, visibility from 15 mi to unlimited, Gander Air Traffic Control reports Navy 6501 only acft in area. SPACECRAFT
Evaluation B-2. Suggest any additional info be secured fr Navy Officers concerned at VRI Sq Patuxent River, Maryland.

ACTION: OIN

CAF IN: 97697

WE HAD NO SUCH REQUEST

(11 Feb 51)

SER/rcf

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FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

10 February 1951

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~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

I, Graham E. BETHUNE, was Co-Pilot on Flight 125 from Keflavik, Iceland to Naval Air Station, Argentia on the 10th of February 1951. At 0055Z I signed and observed the following object:

While flying in the left seat at 10,000 feet on a true course of 230 degrees at a position of 49-50 North 50-03 West, I observed a glow of light below the horizon about 1,000 to 1,500 feet above the water. Its bearing was about 2 O'Clock. There was no overcast, there was a thin transparent group of scuds at about 2,000 feet altitude. After examining the object for 40 to 50 seconds I called it to the attention of Lieutenant KINGDON in the right hand seat. It was under the thin scuds at roughly 30 to 40 miles away. I asked "What is it, a ship lighted up or a city, I know it can't be a city because we are over 250 miles out". We both observed its course and motion for about 4 or 5 minutes before calling it to the attention of the other crew members. Its first glow was a dull yellow. We were on an intercepting course. Suddenly its angle of attack changed, its altitude and size increased as though its speed was in excess of 1,000 miles per hour. It closed in so fast that the first feeling was we would collide in mid air. At this time its angle changed and the color changed. It then was definitely circular and redish orange on its primitier. It reversed its course and tripled its speed until it was last seen disappearing over the horizon. Because of our altitude and misleading distance over water it is almost impossible to estimate its size, distance and speed. A rough estimate would be at least 300 feet in diameter, over 1,000 miles per hour in speed and approached within 5 miles of the aircraft.

1,500 FEET

/s/Graham E. BETHUNE
LT, U. S. Naval Reserve.

ENCLOSURE (4)

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